Cedar Valley Family Center AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Luis, operations manager · Next review: in 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take paperwork off your plate. We want to protect families, students and donors, and keep mistakes from going out under our name.

Who it covers. All staff, volunteers, contractors and board members.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Microsoft Copilot:** Pilot users (eight licenses): donor names and gift amounts. No case file or student information.
- **ChatGPT:** Work email only. Nothing about a real person goes in.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Luis approves any new tool, plugin, AI agent or AI feature in software we own. Anything touching client data also needs Grace, our compliance director.
- **Accounts.** Use your work email, and turn off any setting that trains on what you type.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- **Everyone, now.** Anyone may use ChatGPT for work with no information about a real person in it. Copilot pilot users may do the same with Copilot.
- Everyone: reword an email, brainstorm, or explain a form.
- Teachers: lesson plans, reading passages, GED practice questions, and Spanish handout translations. No student names or scores.
- Copilot pilot users (development team and Luis): draft appeals and thank-you letters with donor names; summarize grant guidelines.

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- AI-drafted text in county contract reports or funder grant reports — *Your manager*
- Any AI use with client data — *Luis and Grace*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: Case files (county contract): names, addresses, income, immigration status, domestic violence, mental health and substance use notes. Student records (district agreement): names, grades, scores, attendance. Donor notes. Staff files. Passwords and login details.
- Installing a browser plugin that reads your email.
- Using AI to score intake essays or place adult students in class levels.
- AI-written public statements about the news, or an AI photo passed off as one of our families.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- A person reads everything AI helps write: facts, names, numbers, tone. Check county report numbers against our records. The sender is responsible.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides who gets emergency assistance funds. Caseworkers and their supervisor decide. AI may only help with wording or ideas.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- A person signs thank-you letters. Label materials AI helped make, like reading passages. Answer funders honestly when they ask about AI.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell Luis and Grace the same day. For client data, Grace decides if it is a breach. Reporting a mistake is expected, not punished.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- Luis keeps this policy current and runs an hour of training. The board approves changes. We review it in 12 months.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Should we buy ChatGPT Team, extend Copilot to everyone, or neither?
- May AI help with case notes, and what does the county allow?
- Will we approve Canva's AI image tools, which communications uses now?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.